

CarMax Use Case - 4.29.26

Use Case: Ability to heart (or favorite) cars directly within the body of the email and have that write back to their profile.

MCE Solution:

Marketing Cloud doesn't natively support heart/favorite interactions within emails. However, you can simulate it using a click-based mechanism:

1. **Clickable "Heart" link in the email** — Each car listing in the email gets a unique tracked link (using Marketing Cloud's link tracking or a custom redirect URL) tied to that specific vehicle VIN or listing ID.
2. **CloudPages or API Event** — When the customer clicks the heart, they land on a CloudPage or trigger an API event that:
 - Captures who clicked (via contact key/subscriber key in the URL)
 - Captures which car was favorited (via a parameter in the URL)
3. **Write back to the CarMax profile** — The CloudPage or event fires an API call (REST or SOAP) back to CarMax's backend system to update the customer's favorited vehicles in their profile. If the customer isn't logged in, you need a way to link the email click to their CarMax account, so subscriber key to customer ID mapping is critical.

MCA Solution:

Since MCA is natively connected to the Salesforce Data Cloud and CRM, the writeback story gets much cleaner.

1. **Email built in MCA** — Each car has a tracked link with the vehicle ID as a parameter
2. **Click fires a Data Cloud Streaming API event** — The click URL hits a real-time ingestion endpoint in Data Cloud, passing subscriber key + vehicle ID
3. **Data Cloud updates the Unified Profile** — The favorited vehicle gets written to a related object/engagement record on the customer profile
4. **CarMax CRM/App picks it up** — Since it's on the Salesforce platform, their CarMax profile app (if on Salesforce) can surface the favorite in near real-time

Key Advantages of using MCA vs MCE for this use case:

MCE	MCA
Requires CloudPage + custom API	Native Data Cloud writeback
Manual identity stitching	Built-in identity resolution
Siloed engagement data	Unified profile enrichment
Custom dev needed	Lower-code options available